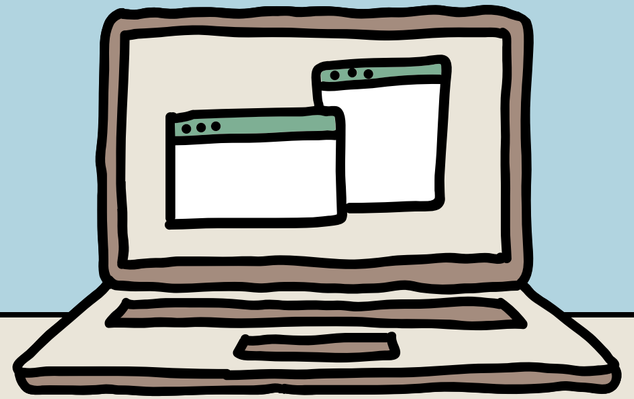
Sentence Errors

Functional English

SE-359

Ms. Kulsoom Salman





Introduction

- Sentence errors affect clarity, coherence, and effectiveness.
- Understanding and correcting errors improves writing skills.
- This topic covers four major sentence errors.
- **Why do you think sentence structure is important in writing?**



Major Sentence Errors

Sentence Fragments

A sentence fragment is a group of words that does not form a complete sentence because it lacks one or more essential components: a subject, a verb, or a complete thought. Such fragments create confusion by presenting incomplete or disconnected ideas.

Run-on Sentences

A run-on sentence occurs when two or more independent clauses are improperly joined without the necessary punctuation or conjunctions. Run-on sentences disrupt the logical flow
of ideas and cause comprehension difficulties.

Comma Splices

A comma splice occurs when two independent clauses are joined solely by a comma without an appropriate coordinating conjunction. This error creates ambiguity and disrupts the flow of information.

Misplaced and Dangling Modifiers

A modifier is a word, phrase, or clause that provides additional information about another element in a sentence. Misplaced modifiers appear too far from the word they modify, while dangling modifiers are disconnected from any clear referent.



Sentence Fragments

- A group of words that lacks a subject, verb, or complete thought.
- Causes confusion due to incomplete ideas.

Causes:

- Dependent clauses as independent sentences.
- Missing subject.
- Missing verb.
- Phrase fragments.
- **Incorrect:** Because the experiment failed.
- **Correct:** The project was delayed because the experiment failed.

How to Correct Sentence Fragments?



- Attach the fragment to a complete sentence.
- Add the missing subject or verb.
- Reorganize the structure.

Correcting Sentence Fragments

Try correcting these sentence fragments

Missing Subject

Ran the statistical analysis.

Missing Verb

The significance of the findings.

Phrase Fragments

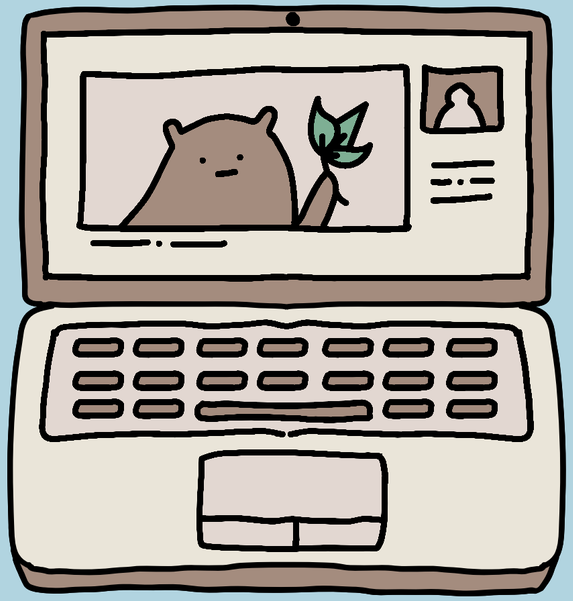
In the middle of the presentation.

Run-On Sentences (Fused Sentences)

- Two or more independent clauses joined incorrectly.
- Causes confusion and disrupts logical flow.

Example

  - Incorrect: The research was completed the results were published.
  - Correct: The research was completed, and the results were published.





Correcting Run-on Sentences

- Use a period to separate clauses.
- Use a semicolon for closely related clauses.
- Add a comma and coordinating conjunction (and, but, so, yet, etc.).

Example:

- Incorrect: The report was incomplete and the deadline was approaching.
- Correct: The report was incomplete, so the team worked overtime.

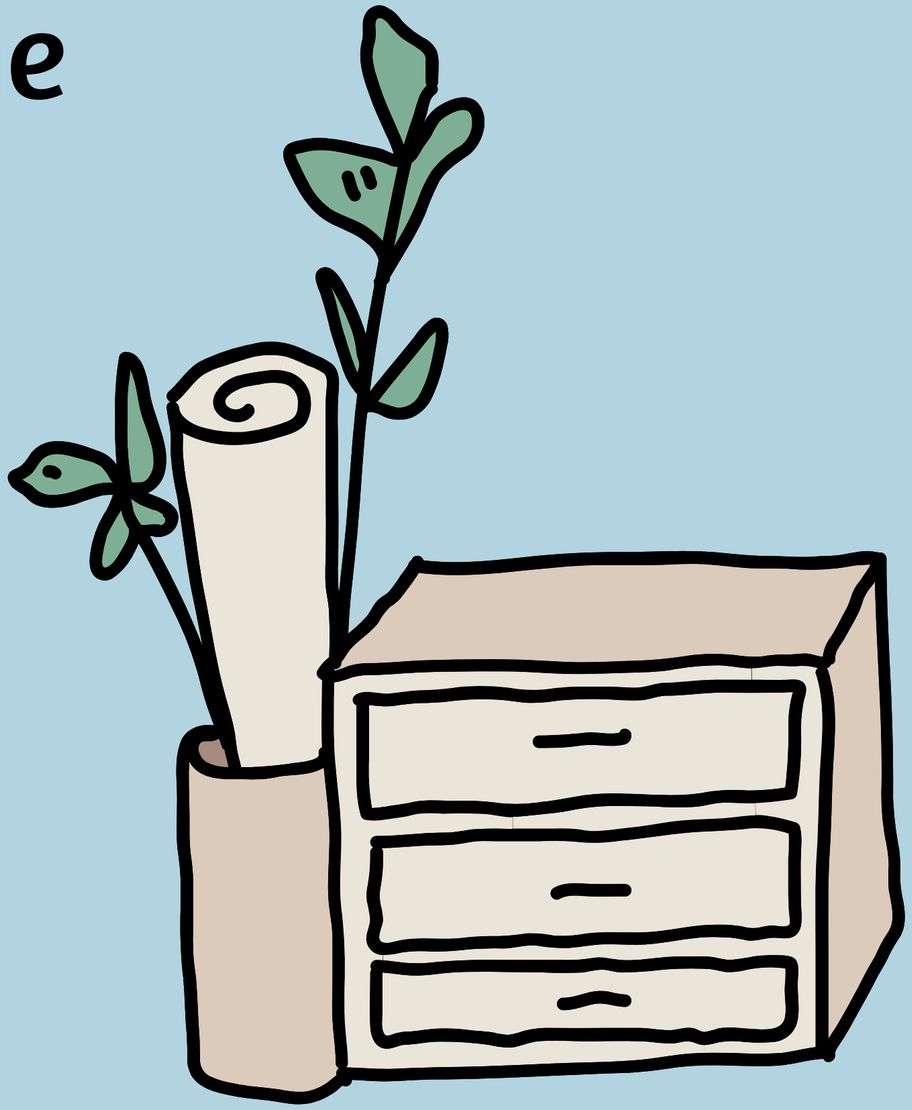
Quick Exercise: Choose the correct fix:

"The weather was nice we went for a walk."

A) The weather was nice; we went for a walk.

B) The weather was nice, and we went for a walk.

C) Both A & B





Comma Splices

- Two independent clauses joined only by a comma.
- Creates ambiguity and disrupts flow.

Causes:

- Misunderstanding punctuation rules.
- Incorrectly assuming a comma is enough to connect ideas.

Example:

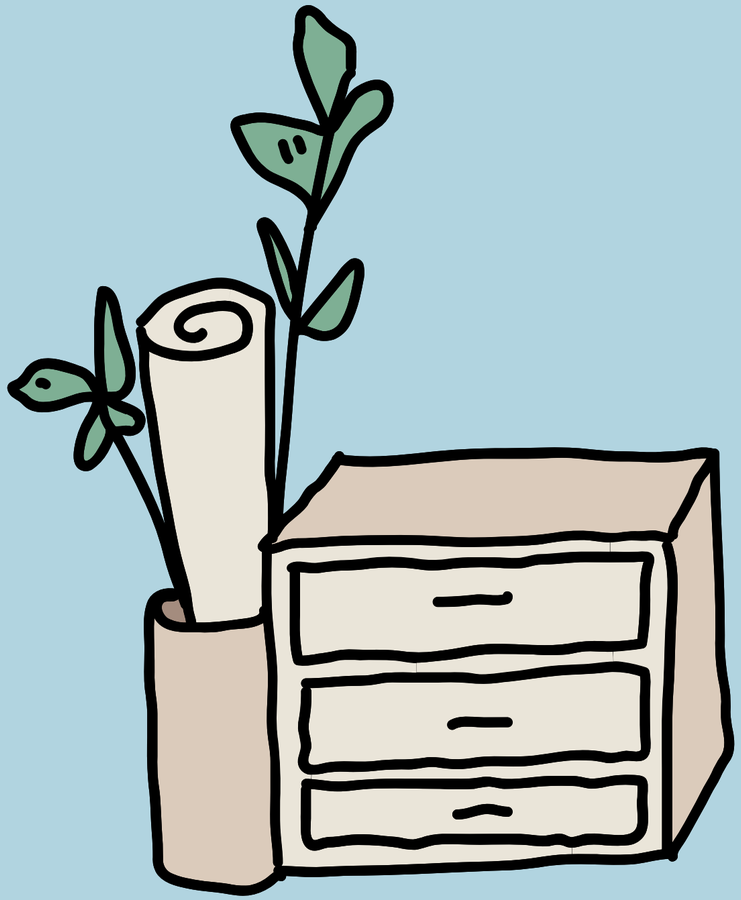
- Incorrect: The lecture was engaging, the students asked many questions.
- Correct: The lecture was engaging, and the students asked many questions.

Fixing Comma Splices

- Replace the comma with a period.
- Use a semicolon for related ideas.
- Add a coordinating conjunction.

Example:

- Incorrect: The software update was released, users reported issues.
- Correct: The software update was released. Users reported issues.



Misplaced and Dangling Modifiers

- A modifier provides extra information about another word.
- Misplaced: Too far from the word it modifies.
- Dangling: No clear referent in the sentence.



Examples:

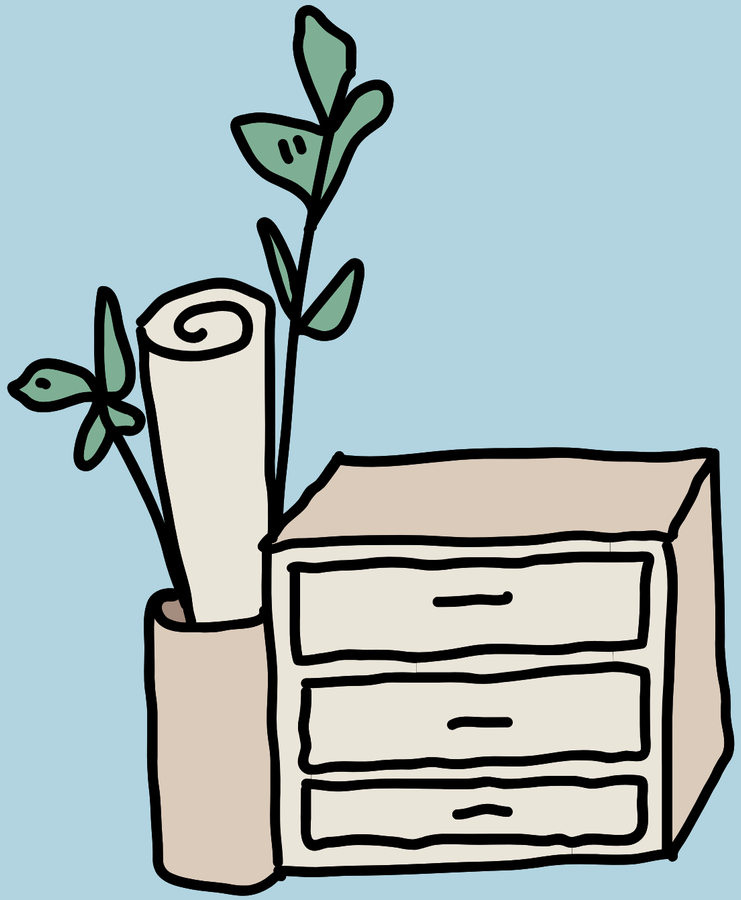
- **Misplaced Modifier:**
- Incorrect: She served sandwiches to the children on paper plates.
- Correct: She served sandwiches on paper plates to the children.
- **Dangling Modifier:**
- Incorrect: After analyzing the data, the conclusion was clear.
- Correct: After analyzing the data, the researchers concluded the results were significant.

Fixing Modifier Errors

- Place modifiers close to the word they modify.
- Ensure the subject of the sentence is mentioned.
- Reconstruct sentences for clarity.

Example:

- Incorrect: Driving down the street, the flowers were beautiful.
- Correct: Driving down the street, she admired the beautiful flowers.





Conclusion

- Sentence errors affect readability and professionalism.
- Recognizing and correcting them improves writing clarity.
- Use proper punctuation, structure, and modifie to enhance communication

Thank you for listening.



